

players and social service into gnome shell and what not. It's these little changes over time that increasingly increased the interest of new as well as already interested users.

The cherry on the topping was the awesome 'no drivers required' approach. Ubuntu made it easy for users to plug in their mobile phones, select their country, fill in a few details and get ready with a GPRS connection. This was, and still is, a huge boost for people (mostly students) who live in places where they can't afford to have wired connections or costly wireless plans.

For some users, the last mentioned feature (built-in drivers) is most important. Although you won't find Pentium 4 processors in the market anymore, some still use such machines just because it does all they want it to do. These users don't upgrade either due to monetary problems or because they're simply happy with the PC which taught them what a computer is. The bigger problem with owners of 'boxes' such as these is more on the side of support than features. If you lost the only copy of the driver CD of the motherboard for a P4 computer today, you will be forced to buy a new system. The reason is lack of support from the manufacturer. In all probabilities, manufacturers would have stopped supporting the device. So you wouldn't get the drivers on their web site, with little luck getting it elsewhere either. Since the Linux kernel has a huge database of drivers, Ubuntu gives you reason to rejoice. It brings life back to such old PCs. While system requirements of most other new operating systems for running are high, Ubuntu doesn't need much to get great performance from older machines. While 512 MB RAM might seem a little less for Windows 7 or Windows Vista, Ubuntu can not only be used on such systems but can also perform pretty decently.

In case that description suggests even in the slightest of ways that Ubuntu (or any other Linux distribution) is meant to run on slow devices, you might be enlightened to know that most supercomputers in the world today use Linux as their operating system. All these facts and features make Ubuntu more popular than any other Linux distribution.

Who can use Ubuntu?

If you were to ask this question to the creators of Ubuntu, they would say 'anyone', and they wouldn't be wrong. Ubuntu comes with almost all software which you would require as a normal computer user. We know demands differ, so let's look at the valley from different mountains: